# Mengran Gu

Concept Art Lead

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**Lead concept artist with 4+ years owning character pipelines on a live MMO project. Specialized in stylized character design, world-building systems, and cross-discipline collaboration with 3D, design, and marketing teams. Proven ability to define visual direction, scale production pipelines, and deliver cohesive, production-ready assets.**

## Experience

### Lead 2D Concept Artist

Clockwork Labs — ***BitCraft Online*** 2022.2-Present

- **Owned and directed the full character art pipeline** across characters, creatures, and modular apparel systems
- Defined visual language across factions, ensuring stylistic consistency and scalability
- Collaborated with 3D and technical teams to deliver production-ready turnarounds and material callouts
- Built modular clothing and creature systems to expand content while maintaining cohesion
- Produced marketing key art supporting brand and player acquisition

### Freelance Concept Artist

Shangties Studio — ***Marvel Rivals*** 2024.9-2024.11

- Created cinematic matte paintings and environment concepts for in-game sequences
- Maintained strict adherence to AAA IP visual standards
- Collaborated with internal teams to ensure visual continuity

### Contract 2D Concept & Illustrator

Funovus — ***Wild Sky (Mobile)*** 2021.3- 2021.12

- Designed stylized hero characters and creatures
- Developed themed skins and seasonal content
- Produced promotional assets for live events

### Freelance Visual Development Artist & Illustrator 2021-Present

- Created color keys and lighting studies to define cinematic mood, composition, and storytelling beats
- Splash art illustrations and character commissions.

## Education

**Academy of Art University**
MFA in Concept Art
2018.8-2021.12

**University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign**
B.S. in Industrial design
2014.9-2018.5

## Skills

### Art Direction & Leadership

Character Visual Development (Stylized)
Faction & World-Building Systems
Visual Language Definition
Pipeline Ownership & Scalability
Cross-Discipline Collaboration

### Production & Execution

Character / Creature Design
Turnarounds & 3D Handoff Packages
Material & Costume Design Systems
Key Art & Marketing Illustration

### Software

Photoshop (Expert)
Procreate
Adobe Premiere
Illustrator
Zbrush
Autodesk Maya
Blender

### Languages

Chinese (Native)
English (proficient)
Japanese (proficient)